

Access to University



Refugee Education UK

What we will cover

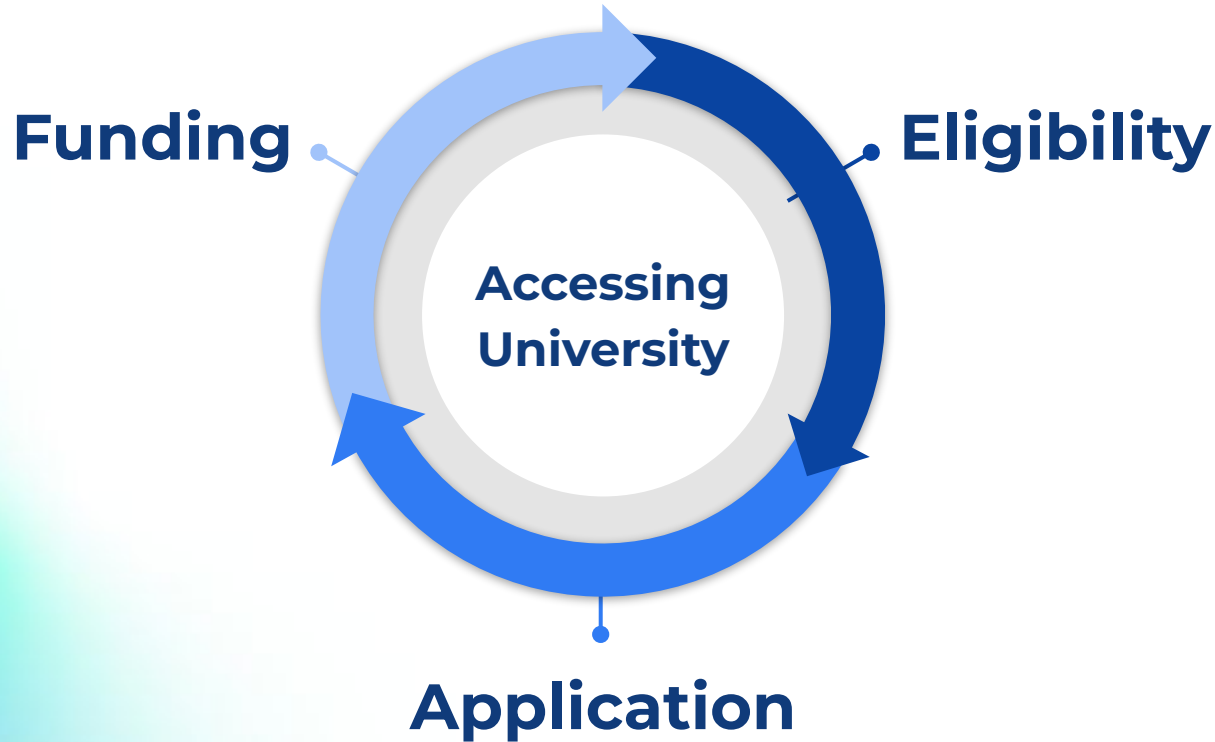
- Eligibility
- Application process
- Funding options
- Support resources



Access

Develop an understanding what is required to access University in the UK.

Higher Education



Eligibility

Understand the prerequisites needed prior to applying for university.

What does the education system in the UK look like?

Primary School



- Age: 4 - 11
- Full-time (M-F)
- Cost: Free

Secondary School



- Age: 11-16 or 11-18 (if there is a 6th Form College)
- Full-time (M-F)
- Cost: Free

University



- Age: 18+
- Part or Full-time
- Cost: Not free (Student Finance and scholarships)

Sixth Form



- 16-18
- Full-time (M-F)
- Cost: Free

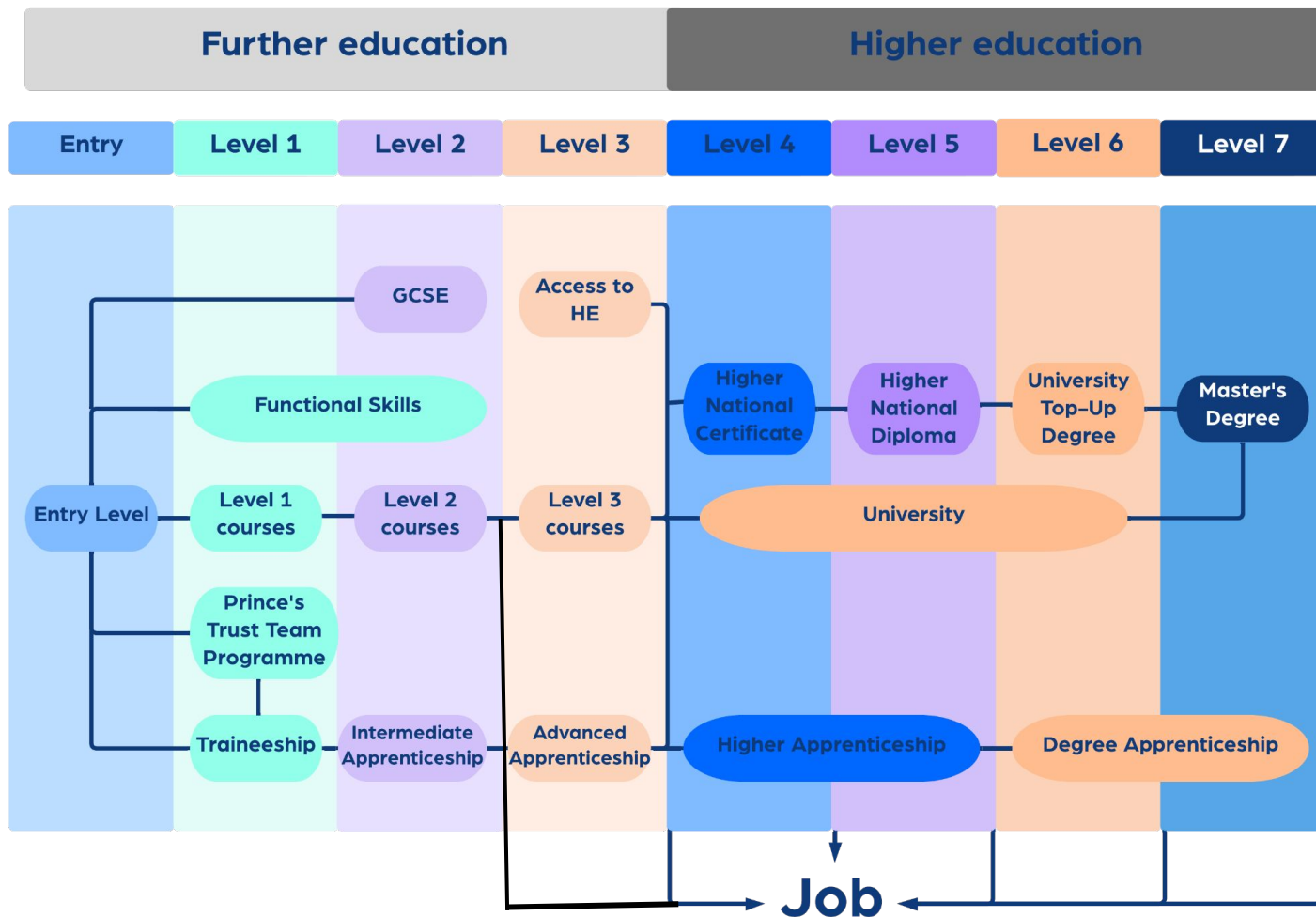


Further Education College

- Age: 16+
- Part or Full-time
- Cost: 16-18 Free, 19+ Some courses are free and others are not free.



Levels of Education



For information about career routes, visit
<https://nationalcareers.service.gov.uk/>
 and select 'Search job profiles'



Examples of a full Level 2



- BTEC Extended Diploma (L2)
- 5 GCSEs grade 4-9
- Intermediate Apprenticeship

Examples of a full Level 3



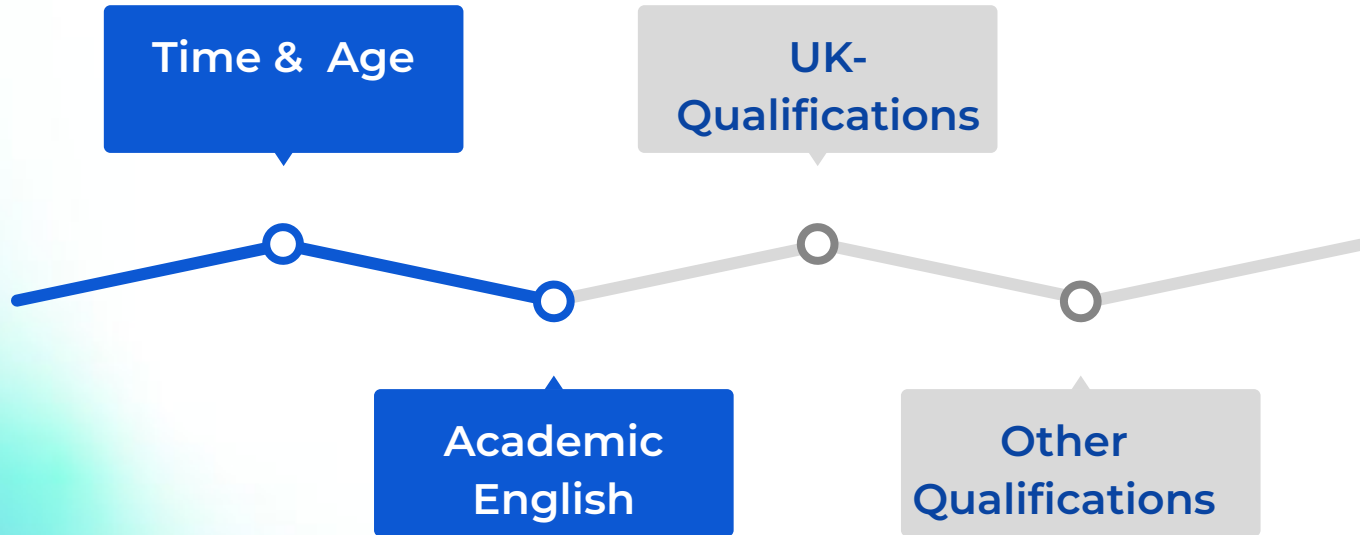
- A Levels
- Access to HE Diploma
- BTEC National Extended Diploma (L3)
- Foundation Year (University)
- Advanced Apprenticeship



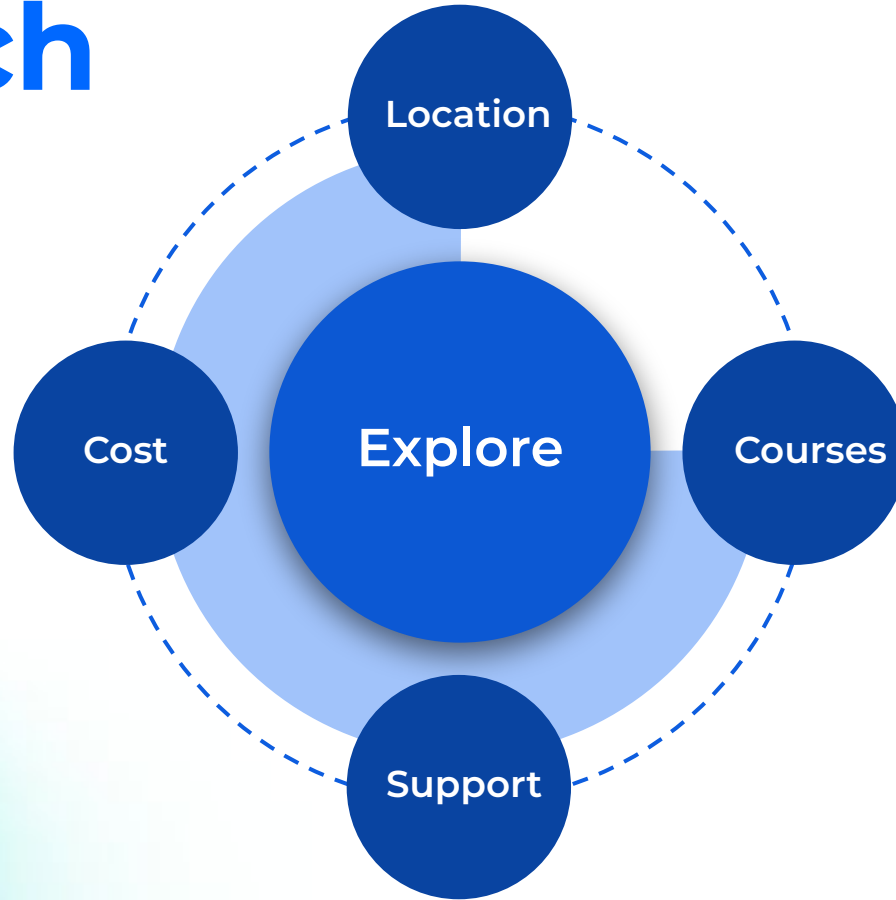
Application

Develop an understanding of the application process.

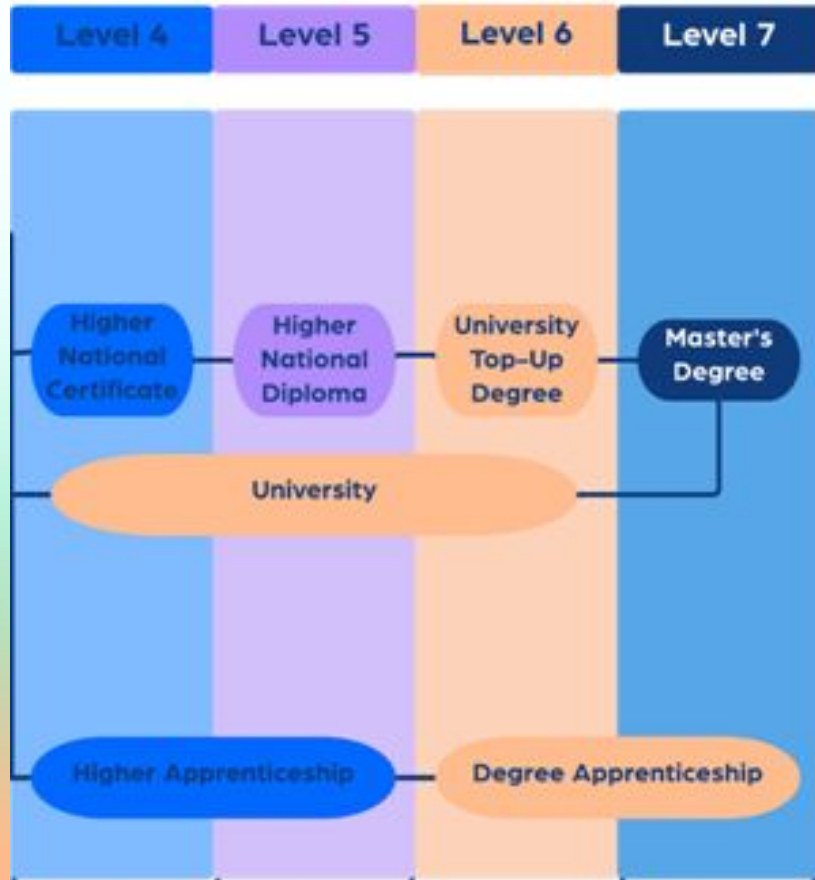
Prerequisites



Research



Higher education



Undergraduate	Postgraduate
→ Bachelor's Degree → Graduate Certificate → Integrated Master's → Top up degree → Foundational degree → Apprenticeship degree → Higher National Cert → Higher National Deg → Diploma of Higher Education	→ Master's degree (MA) → Masters of Business Administration (MBA) → Postgraduate Certificate in Education (PGCE) → Postgraduate top up degree → Postgraduate Diploma → Postgraduate Certificate → Doctorate (PhD)

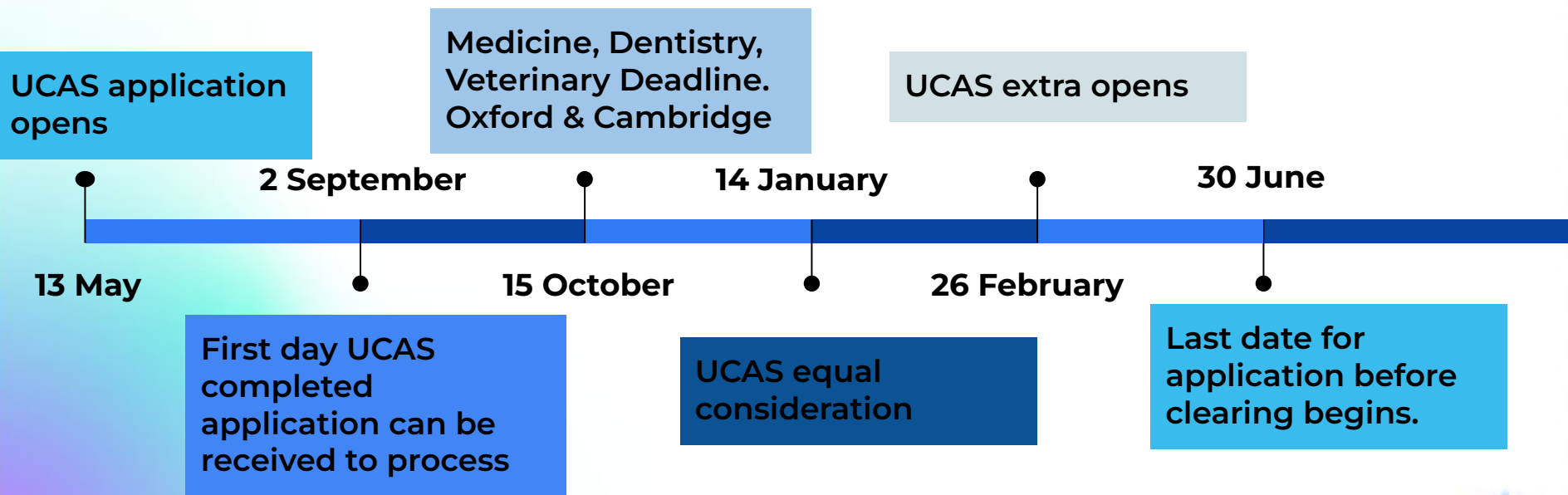
<https://www.port.ac.uk/student-life/help-and-advice/applying-to-uni/university-awards-explained>

<https://www.thecompleteuniversityguide.co.uk/student-advice/what-to-study/types-of-degrees-uk>



UCAS application entry dates

2026/27 entry



Your **choices**

 **Add choice**

[Confirm choices](#)

My profile

Personal details > Name, age, title and gender ✓ Section complete	Contact and residency details > Address, email, telephone and where you live ✓ Section complete	Education > Qualifications and periods of study ✓ Section complete
Employment > Employment, paid, unpaid, or volunteer work ✓ Section complete	Nationality details > Birthplace and nationalities ✓ Section complete	Supporting information > So that providers know how to support you during your studies ✓ Section complete
English language skills > Is English your first language? ✓ Section complete	Finance and funding > Tell us how you'll fund your study ✓ Section complete	Diversity and inclusion > Only shared with a provider once you have a place on your application is archived ✓ Section complete

Your personal statement and references

Personal statement > Why do you want to study this subject? ✓ Section complete	Reference > Provide details of your referees 🕒 Section in progress
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Application process

- Complete UCAS Profile
- Decide your course
- Choose your universities
- Write Personal statement
- Experiences
- References
- Scholarships



Decision

Universities will review your:



Personal Statement



Qualifications



Reference

They may also ask for:



Admission Test



Interview



Portfolio/ audition



Acceptance

- Conditional
- Unconditional
- Firm vs Insurance Choice
- Scholarships
- Interview for Scholarships



Funding

Develop an understanding of the funding options available.

Funding Options

Grants/ Bursaries

Charities/
Organisations

Friends

Student Finance

Family

Scholarships-
University/
Private

Crowdfunding/
Fund Me



Student Finance

- Tuition Fee Loan
- Maintenance Loan
- Extra Support
- Apply Online
- SF assesses application
- Receive funds
- Repayment



Student Finance Eligibility

Residency Category	Ordinary Residency	Support Available
Indefinite Leave to Enter/ Remain	3 Years UK	Full SFE Support
Refugee Humanitarian Protection ILR Domestic Violence ILR Bereaved Partner	N/A (Providing UK residency maintained since status awarded)	Full SFE Support
Stateless Persons Section 67 or Calais Leave ARAP/ARCRS/Pitting Leave Ukraine Scheme Leave	N/A (Providing UK residency maintained since status awarded)	Full SFE Support
Long Residency	Under 18: 7 Years UK Over 18: Half life/20 Years UK Inc. 3 Years Ordinary Lawful UK Residency	Full SFE Support

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1RHIIInPKtOrcvsU84rLFwIsHUsMxRHSba/view>

Funding Option	Tuition	Living costs	Eligibility Criteria
Scholarship (Sanctuary University)	✓	✓	• Excellence in academics, sports or the ARTs • University specific or regional
Bursary	✗	✓	• Awarded to low household income, background or personal circumstances •
Grant	✗	✓	• Awarded to low household income, background or personal circumstances •



Scholarships, Bursaries & Grants



Student Action
for Refugees

RefuAid
Hope.Resilience.Ur

Universities  of Sanctuary


Refugee Education UK

turn
2US Tackling
financial
insecurity
together.



Schwab & Westheimer Trust
Educational Support for Refugees

Displaced Student Portal

[Home](#)[For Applicants](#)[For Providers](#)[Further Support](#)[Resources](#)[About Us](#)

Displaced Student Opportunities UK

Study opportunities to support refugees and people seeking asylum in the UK to access university

[Learn More](#)[Browse Opportunities](#)

Immigration Status

Select Options



Level of Study

Select Options



Type of opportunity

Select Options



Location

Select Options

[Filter Opportunities](#)

Scholarships, Bursaries & Grants



Student Action
for Refugees

Filter by region		Filter by level of study		Filter by immigration status		Search the table	
All		Undergraduate		Ukraine schemes			
University	Region	Level of study	Immigration status	Offering	Website	Opening date	Closing date
Bath Spa	South West	Undergraduate	- Asylum seeker - LLR/DLR* - Humanitarian protection - Refugee status - Ukraine schemes	£2,000 per year - Accommodation for one year (if required) - Fee waiver (if ineligible for student finance)	Bath Spa University Sanctuary Scholarship	Closed for 2024	Closed for 2024
Cardiff Metropolitan	Wales	- Undergraduate - Postgraduate (Master's)	- Asylum seeker - DLR - Humanitarian Protection - Refugee Status - Ukraine schemes	- Fee waiver - Bus pass - Lunch vouchers - Personal support	Cardiff Met Sanctuary Award	March 2025	Closed for 2024
Chester	North West	- Undergraduate - Postgraduate	- Asylum seeker - DLR/LLR* - Ukraine schemes	- Fee waiver - Up to £2,500 per year in-kind support package - Personal support	Sanctuary Award	January 2025	Closed for 2024

Applying for funding

- Research
- Eligibility Criteria
- Application- requirements
- Personal/ support statement
- Interview for Scholarships



Post Graduate

Research

- Prerequisite requirements
- Course structure and content
- University and Degree type
- Career prospects

Apply

- [Myriad UCAS APP](#)
- Directly with the university
- Personal statement
- Research proposal (PhD)

Funding

- Masters loan & Doctoral loan (refugees)
- Studentships (requires work permit)
- Scholarships, grants and bursaries
- Applications, personal statements, interviews

Support

To know of support
resources available
for you.

Support

University:

- ❖ Student Advice Services
- ❖ Financial Advice Services
- ❖ Admissions Team
- ❖ Academic/ Study Skills Hub
- ❖ UCAS- University & College Admissions Services
- ❖ UKCISA- International Student Affairs
- ❖ Universities of Sanctuary
- ❖ Displaced Student Portal

Charity organisations:

- ★ Refugee Education (REUK)
- ★ Student Action for Refugees (STAR)
- ★ We Belong
- ★ Coram CIC- Children's Legal
- ★ Refugee Action
- ★ Refugee Council
- ★ Refuaid
- ★ Refugee Study
- ★ Breaking Barriers
- ★ Refugee Employment



How to find us

- **Advice Line:**
www.reuk.org/advice
- Facebook: Refugee Education UK
- BlueSky: @refugeeeduk.bsky.social
- Instagram: @RefugeeEdUK
- Sign up to our newsletter
(www.reuk.org/keepupdated)